

30 Minutes Expert Backup Plans

So you have a backup of all the data in your computer. But can you say the same about your e-mail? Your mail could go missing if in one of your more lightheaded moments you let your fingers wander over the keyboard or mouse and accidentally click on delete. Or they could be lost if your hard disk decides to belly up and crash. Whatever the case, keeping a backup of your correspondence is all too vital.

Outlook Express is one of the simplest e-mail clients to use, and when it comes to backing up mail, it's no different. Just follow these steps and you'll be safely through.

STEP 1 Create a new folder in a separate partition and then start Outlook Express.

STEP 2 Select **Tools > Options** in Outlook Express.

STEP 3 Click on the 'Maintenance' tab and then on the 'Store Folder' button. This will bring up the 'Store Location' dialog box. The path displayed here tells you where all your mail is currently stored.



Change the path where the mail is stored

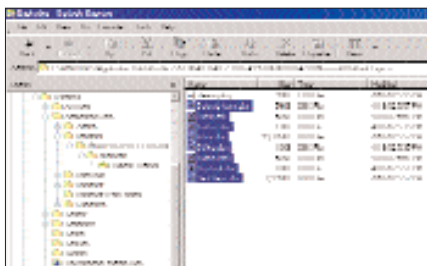
TIP Remember that it is best to store your mail on a separate partition or another hard drive, one not containing the OS. This is to avoid any mail loss in case your OS gets corrupted.

STEP 4 Click on the 'Change' button. This lets you choose a new location for storing your mail. Now, select the new folder you created. You will see the 'Store Location' dialog box again with the new location when you are done.

STEP 5 You will be prompted to relaunch Outlook Express for the change in location to take effect. Do so, and you will find that your e-mail files have been moved to the new folder.

STEP 6 To do an actual backup of your e-mail, go to Windows Explorer and navigate to the new e-mail folder.

Backup the contents of the entire folder (the files will have a .dbx extension) to another location so you can access them later if something goes wrong with your Outlook Express. It is



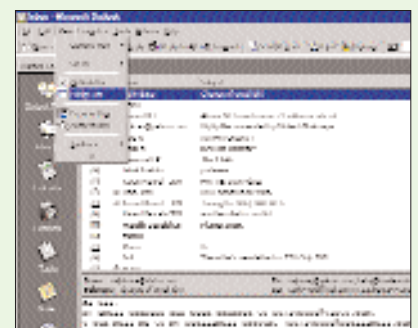
Copy the .dbx files and take backups

advisable to back it up on a CD-RW or CD-R disc so that in case your hard disk crashes, your mail data is not lost. Congratulations. You've now backed up your mail! Easy, wasn't it? 

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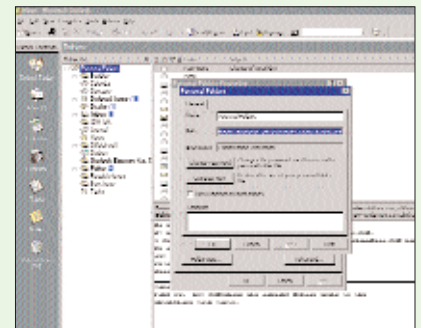
Backing up in MS Outlook

STEP 1 To backup mail in Microsoft Outlook, go to **View > Folder List**. This will show you the list of all the mail folders you have.



Select View > Folder List to see the mail folders

STEP 2 Right-click on 'Personal Folders'. Select the 'Properties for Personal Folders' option and click on the 'Advanced' button. This brings up the 'Personal Folders' dialog box.



Copy the path where your Outlook.pst file is stored

STEP 3 Copy the path of the folder in which the Outlook.pst file is stored. This file contains all your mail. Make sure to click on the 'Compact Now' button to reduce the size of your personal folder. Now in Windows Explorer, navigate to the Outlook.pst file and copy it to another location. Click on 'OK'. You now have a backup of all your mail.